



Raynal Lucas Sordes Ellis

1896 – 1915

Civilian Research

Field Name	Field Data	Source of data
Casualty Name	Raynal Lucas Sordes Ellis	CWGC
Date of Birth	1896 Longsight, Manchester Registered in the Sep Qtr 1896 in the Chorlton reg district	1911 census GRO
Date of Death (from Spreadsheet)	20/09/1915 Died of dysentery Soldiers Died in the Great War	CWGC Index to East Mudros Military Cemetery, Lemnos, Greece on CWGC site. Copy saved. Transcript saved on file

Age at death (from Spreadsheet	19	CWGC
Marital Status	Single	
Children (if any)	None	
Occupation prior to Call up		
Parents	Son of Charles Sordes Ellis and Evelyn Ann Ellis, of 308, King St., Hammersmith, London. An Old Lyonian.	CWGC
Listed Address(s)	24 Station Road, Wealdstone	1911 census
Parents /Fathers occupation	Works chemist & buyer (chemicals)	1911 census
Brothers and Sisters	Muriel Sordes Ellis (younger), Winnifred Sordes Ellis (younger)	1911 census
Years at John Lyon School		
University (if any)/Other Ed	See below – Pittman shorthand	
Obituary		
Additional sources of data		
War Memorials:	John Lyon School, plaque	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/name/340970
	John Lyon School, sundial	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/name/341275
	St Mark's Church, London Road, opposite Marina Drive, Rosherville, Northfleet, Gravesham, Kent	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/name/1511225

Military Research

JLS WWI RoH	ELLIS R.L.S.
CWGC Reference	https://www.cwgc.org/find-war-dead/casualty/626124/ellis,-raynal-lucas-sordes/
Age	19
DoD	20-Sep-15
Rank	Pte
Regiment	Wiltshire Regiment 5th Bn
Location	EAST MUDROS MILITARY CEMETERY - Greece
Military details	Son of Charles Sordes Ellis and Evelyn Ann Ellis, of 308, King St., Hammersmith, London. An Old Lyonian. Private Raynal Lucas Sordes Ellis (Service Number 11689) died at the age of 19 on September 20, 1915. He served with the Wiltshire Regiment. He passed away on the Greek island of Lemnos. During the Gallipoli Campaign, Lemnos acted as a vital Allied hospital and logistics hub. He succumbed either to combat wounds or rampant diseases like dysentery while stationed there. He is buried at the East Mudros Military Cemetery on Lemnos, Greece. His family resided in Hammersmith, London. He went to school as an Old Lyonian at the Lower School of John Lyon. (RBL source)

Story of Sacrifice

Raynal Lucas Sordes Ellis (1896–1915)

Civilian Life

Raynal Ellis was born in Longsight, Manchester, in 1896 and was raised in a family headed by Charles Sordes Ellis, a works chemist and chemical buyer, and Evelyn Ann Ellis. By 1911 the family was living at 24 Station Road, Wealdstone, and Raynal was the eldest of three children, with two younger sisters, Muriel and Winnifred. He attended the John Lyon School, becoming one of its Old Lyonians.

Although little survives about his everyday life, contemporary newspaper records provide several glimpses of his interests and abilities. In 1908 he took part in a local cricket match connected with a fête at Wembley Park. He is recorded as the match scorer but the newspaper also noted that the fielding of "Woodbridge, Sands and Ellis was good," showing that he contributed both on and off the field. He was playing alongside fellow Old Lyonian, Woodbridge.

Another record from October 1914 shows that Ellis passed a Pitman's shorthand speed examination at 70 words per minute, demonstrating proficiency in a valuable commercial skill of the period.

Military Life

Following the outbreak of the First World War, Raynal enlisted in the 5th Battalion, Wiltshire Regiment in September 1914. After approximately nine months of training in Britain, he was sent to the Mediterranean and landed at Cape Helles during the Gallipoli Campaign.

During the campaign he contracted dysentery and was evacuated to Lemnos, the Greek island that served as an important Allied hospital and logistics base for the Gallipoli operations. After recovering, he was attached to colonial troops serving at Anzac Cove. Letters sent home described the strenuous nature of the work, and his final letter, dated 13 September 1915, was reported by his family to have been cheerful.

Raynal Lucas Sordes Ellis died of dysentery on 20 September 1915, just after his nineteenth birthday. He is buried in East Mudros Military Cemetery on Lemnos, Greece, and is commemorated by the Commonwealth War Graves Commission and on memorials at the John Lyon School and St Mark's Church, Northfleet. At 6 feet 4 inches, his obituary described him as the tallest man in the Wiltshire Regiment.

Photo

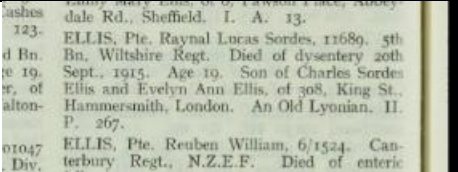


Ellis Original Photo



Ellis AI Photo

Notes and Clippings

Index to East Mudros Military Cemetery, Lemnos, Greece	
	From the Centenary issue of the Lyonian, researched by pupils 2014 Ellis, R L S Raynal Lucas Sordes Ellis was a private in the 5th battalion Wiltshire regiment who died on 20th September 1915 aged 19 at Gallipoli. He was the Son of Charles Sordes Ellis and Evelyn Ann Ellis, of 308, King St., Hammersmith, London. An Old Lyonian. He is remembered at East Mudros Military Cemetery.

THE OBSERVER, FRIDAY, JULY 10, 1908.

ROW ST. MARY'S.

Recreation Ground, the
runs. Scores :—

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Barnes	2
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...	9
...	8
...	6
...	2
...	0
...	9
...	54

RY S.

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...	3
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...	8
...	0
...	4
...	6
...	2
...	0
...	4
...	9
...	45

N HILL SCHOOL.

Harrow Recreation
it being a win for the

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...	3
...	11
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...	4
...	1
...	5
...	45
L.	
...	18

WILLESDEN v. REST OF THE DIVISION.

The most successful portion of the Conservative fete at Wembley Park on Saturday was the cricket match, Willesden v. Rest of the Division. The captain of the latter won the toss, and he was congratulated on having luck ; but it ended with the spin of the coin. Sands and Tooze opened the batting, Holland bowling from the pavilion end and Hersey from the other. Tooze was bowled after a few minutes' play, and disaster followed disaster until Elmslie joined Sands, when a useful stand was made, which carried the score from 43 to 64. After this, Elmslie leaving for a well-played 13, the end soon came for a total of 73, Sands carrying out his bat for an almost faultless 38, with the exception of a difficult chance when he had scored 30. On resuming after lunch Holland and Pinkham commenced the innings for Willesden to the bowling of Tooze, pavilion end, and Sands, and both played with great confidence, but at 28 one of Tooze's slows was too slow for Holland, who was easily caught at square leg, and immediately after Pinkham gave an easy chance in the same place from a similar ball. The remainder of the batsmen did nothing of note. Pinkham continued to play a brilliant game and could get no one to stop with him long, six wickets falling for 89, and the next 3 at 99. Parker then joined Pinkham and quickly made 14, when he gave way to the skipper. Woodbridge, however, clean bowled Pinkham, who thus was the last man out, with a fine 84 with only two chances, both lofty miss-hits from Tooze's slows. The fielding of Willesden was everything that could be desired, very little being given away in the field, and it would be invidious to make distinctions. Unfortunately, the Rest were unable to get as good a team as their captain wished, having had several disappointments at the last moment. The fielding of Woodbridge, Sands and Ellis was good. Batchelor, however, was excellent, and saved many runs by his brilliant fielding. Tooze's eight wickets for 64 runs was, however, a most creditable performance, and he nearly did the "hat" trick into the bargain. Messrs. R. Haylor and S. C. Wakefield acted as umpires, and the scoring was done by Messrs. H. W. Walgrave and Raynal L. Sordes Ellis.

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From the Gravesend Northfleet Standard 2/10/1914

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Elementary.—Pass: Frederick W. Arnold, Florence Bown, Arthur Dunn, Hilda Charlton, Ellen Clare, Ada Cullum, Louis Edwards, Dorothy Frisby, Winifred A. Forder, Florence E. Hodder, Leslie K. Pickering, Victor Pressley, Ethel Stedman, and Charles White.

Theory, pass: Edith Bown.

Speed, pass: Raynal S. Ellis (70 words per minute), Arthur Mills (140 words per minute).

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PTE. R. L. SORDES ELLIS.

The many friends in this district of Mr. C. Sordes Ellis (a late member of the Wealdstone Council) will be sorry to hear that he has lost his only son at the Dardanelles. Pte. Raynal L. Sordes Ellis was educated at the John Lyon School, where he was exceptionally popular with all in the School. He joined the 5th Wilts in September, 1914, and after nine months' home training was drafted with his Regiment to the Mediterranean, and landed at Cape Helles. After a time, he and many of his comrades were stricken with dysentery, and removed to an island in the Aegean Sea. Making rapid recovery, Pte. Sordes Ellis was attached to the Colonials who landed at Anzac Cove. His letters home spoke of the very strenuous work out there, yet in his last letter, of September 13, he was most cheerful. Nothing further was heard of him until the 9th inst., when his parents received the sad news of his death from dysentery on September 20. Pte. Sordes Ellis had just reached his 19th birthday, and was 6ft. 4in. in height, the tallest man in the Regiment.

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